

DSD Assessment Criteria Level 7		Band Descriptors for <u>Essays</u>			
Distinction A+ 80-100	100	Subject Knowledge & Understanding - Deep understanding of key concepts. - Full awareness of specialist literature and in-depth reading.	Intellectual Skills - Convincing argument. - Authoritative analysis with deep critical reflection.	Practical Skills Accurate referencing.	Transferable Skills Excellent written communication and flawless structure.
	95				
	92				
	88				
	85				
	82				
Distinction A 70-79	78	- Highly detailed knowledge and deep understanding of key concepts. - Awareness of specialist literature and in-depth reading.	- Convincing argument. - Extensive analysis with critical reflection.	Accurate referencing.	Excellent written communication and structure.
	75				
	72				
Merit B 60-69	68	- Detailed knowledge and deep understanding. - Wide range of reading material.	- Broadly convincing argument. - Good analysis with critical reflection.	Mostly accurate referencing.	Good written communication and logical structure.
	65				
	62				

Pass C 50-59	58	- Knowledge and understanding demonstrated in specialist areas, but may be incomplete. - Appropriate range of reading material.	- Sound argument but more descriptive than analytical. - Basic analysis with some critical reflection.	Sound referencing with occasional mistakes and errors.	Basic written communication and reasonably logical structure.
	55				
	52				
Marginal Fail D 40-49	48	- General knowledge of concepts. - Limited range of reading material.	- Argument is weak and demonstrates misunderstandings. - Confused or vague analysis with little critical reflection.	Inaccurate or missing references.	Poor written communication and illogical or confusing structure.
	45				
	42				
Fail F+ 30-39	35	- Some knowledge but limited depth. - Poor range of reading material.	- Argument demonstrates deep misunderstandings. - Confused or vague analysis with no critical reflection.	Inaccurate or missing references.	Poor written communication and illogical or confusing structure.
Fail F 1-29	28	- Major gaps in knowledge. - Few sources or inappropriate reading consulted.	Incomplete analysis with no critical reflection.	No references.	Poor written communication and no discernible structure.
	21				
	14				
	7				
Fail FF	0	Non-submission or of no discernible merit.	Non-submission or of no discernible merit.	Non-submission or of no discernible merit.	Non-submission or of no discernible merit.